

Company: Google
Role: Software Engineer
Difficulty: Hard
Round: Technical Round

Overall Experience:

The interview process was highly structured and consisted of three technical rounds.

Round 1: DSA coding. Given a 2D matrix, find the number of islands using BFS/DFS.

Follow-up: how to handle the streaming case where elements are added dynamically.

I used a Disjoint Set Union (DSU) data structure to optimize the follow-up, which the interviewer appreciated.

Round 2: API design and rate limiting. Discussed the token bucket and sliding window algorithms, their pros and cons, and distributed storage implications. We talked about Redis-based implementation and race conditions using Lua scripts.

Round 3: Behavioral round. Discussed conflicts in past team projects and how they were resolved using clear communication and data-driven decisions. Tips: Focus on Googleiness traits.